

Day 59 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in TN History, Culture & Heritage (1)

READING MATERIAL

Covers Tamil Nadu's recent (2025-2026) State Award recipients — each award named after a major Tamil literary/political figure already covered elsewhere in this syllabus — directly relevant to the 'Achievements of Tamil Nadu' and 'Current affairs' clauses.

Q: Who received the Mahakavi Bharathiyar Award 2025, and what is it recognised for?

A: Nello Jayantha — honouring contributions to Tamil poetry and nationalist literary thought (the award is named after Subramania Bharathiyar, already covered in this project's Unit III leaders content).

Q: Who received the Pavendhar Bharathidasan Award 2025, and what does it recognise?

A: The poet Yugabharathi — recognising modern Tamil literary expression and cultural revival (named after the poet Bharathidasan).

Q: Who is set to receive the Thiruvalluvar Award 2026, and what does it recognise?

A: Dr. Sathiyavel Muruganar — recognising contributions toward the promotion of ethical values, Tamil philosophy, and classical Tamil thought (named after Thiruvalluvar, author of the Thirukkural — already covered in depth in this project's dedicated Thirukkural topic).

Q: Who received the Kamarajar Award 2025, and what does it recognise?

A: Idhayathulla — recognising contributions to public life and social development (named after K. Kamaraj, the former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Mahakavi Bharathiyar Award 2025 was given to:

A. Nello Jayantha ✓

B. Yugabharathi

C. Dr. Sathiyavel Muruganar

D. Idhayathulla

Explanation: Nello Jayantha. [medium, web-research]

2. The Pavendhar Bharathidasan Award 2025 was given to:

A. Nello Jayantha

B. Yugabharathi ✓

C. Dr. Sathiyavel Muruganar

D. Idhayathulla

Explanation: Yugabharathi. [medium, web-research]

3. The Thiruvalluvar Award 2026 is set to be given to:

A. Nello Jayantha

B. Yugabharathi

C. Dr. Sathiyavel Muruganar ✓

D. Idhayathulla

Explanation: Dr. Sathiyavel Muruganar. [medium, web-research]

4. The Kamarajar Award 2025 was given to:

A. Nello Jayantha

B. Yugabharathi

C. Dr. Sathiyavel Muruganar

D. Idhayathulla ✓

Explanation: Idhayathulla. [medium, web-research]

5. The Thiruvalluvar Award recognises contributions toward:

A. Sporting excellence

B. Ethical values, Tamil philosophy, and classical Tamil thought ✓

C. Industrial development

D. Film and cinema

Explanation: Ethical values, Tamil philosophy, classical Tamil thought. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Logical Reasoning

READING MATERIAL

Logical Reasoning is 1 of 6 named Reasoning skills (Part B Unit II, 10 questions total for the whole unit). Real exam evidence shows TNPSC's 'logical reasoning' label covers a wide variety of puzzle types, not just classic syllogisms — expect position-counting, ranking-from-clues, and direction-sense questions under this same heading too.

Q: Method — syllogism (statements → which conclusions necessarily follow): Statements: 'Some pens are books. All books are rods.' Conclusions: I. All pens are rods. II. Some pens are rods. III. Some books are pens. IV. All rods are pens. Which conclusions follow?

A: Only II and III follow. 'Some pens are books' + 'All books are rods' guarantees that AT LEAST SOME pens are rods (II) and that some books are indeed pens (III, since 'some pens are books' can be reversed to 'some books are pens'). It does NOT guarantee ALL pens are rods (I — only the 'some' pens that are books are guaranteed to be rods) or that ALL rods are pens (IV — nothing says rods can't include non-pen things).

Q: Method — position-in-a-line counting: Richard is 15th from the front in a column of boys. There are three times as many boys behind him as in front. How many boys are between Richard and the 7th boy from the end?

A: In front of Richard: 14 boys. Behind him: $3 \times 14 = 42$ boys. Total boys = $14 + 1 + 42 = 57$. The 7th from the end is at position $57 - 7 + 1 = 51$ from the front. Richard is at position 15. Boys between them = $51 - 15 - 1 = 35$.

Q: Method — algebraic word problem framed as a 'logical' puzzle: 106 trees were planted; non-fruit-bearing trees were 2 more than thrice the fruit-bearing trees. How many fruit-bearing trees were planted?

A: Let fruit-bearing = x . Non-fruit-bearing = $3x + 2$. Total: $x + 3x + 2 = 106 \rightarrow 4x = 104 \rightarrow x = 26$.

Q: Method — ranking from multiple comparative clues: Given several statements comparing four people's scores (e.g., 'Rama scored more than Rani but less than Rathna...'), determine who scored highest.

A: Work through each comparative clue methodically, building a single ordered chain (e.g., Rathna > Rama > Ramya > Rani), rather than trying to hold all comparisons in your head at once — write the partial order down step by step as each clue is read.

Q: Method — meaningful word sequencing: Arrange in a logical sequence: Honey, Flower, Bee, Wax.

A: Flower → Bee → Honey → Wax. The logic: a bee visits a Flower, produces Honey, and the Honey-making process also yields Wax (beeswax) — order reflects the natural/causal sequence of the process, not alphabetical or arbitrary order.

Q: Method — direction sense: A person starts walking, turns left, then turns left again, and is now heading East. Which direction did they originally start in?

A: West. Two consecutive left turns reverse the original direction (left+left = 180° turn), so if they end up heading East, they must have started heading West.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Statements: 'Some doctors are teachers. All teachers are readers.' Conclusions: I. Some doctors are readers. II. All doctors are readers. III. Some readers are teachers. Which follow?

A. Only I and III ✓

B. Only II

C. All three

D. None

Explanation: I and III follow the same logic as the worked example (some doctors are guaranteed readers via the teacher link; some readers are guaranteed teachers by reversing 'some'). II overreaches — not ALL doctors are teachers, so not all are guaranteed readers. [hard, authored]

2. In a column of boys, Meena is 10th from the front, and there are twice as many boys behind her as in front. How many boys are in the column in total?

A. 27

B. 28 ✓

C. 29

D. 30

Explanation: In front: 9. Behind: $2 \times 9 = 18$. Total = $9 + 1 + 18 = 28$. [medium, authored]

3. A farmer planted 84 saplings in total. The number of flowering saplings was 3 more than twice the number of non-flowering saplings. How many non-flowering saplings were planted?

A. 25

B. 27 ✓

C. 29

D. 31

Explanation: Let non-flowering= x . Flowering= $2x+3$. Total: $x+2x+3=84 \rightarrow 3x=81 \rightarrow x=27$. [medium, authored]

4. Arrange in a logical sequence: Seed, Tree, Fruit, Sapling.

A. Seed-Sapling-Tree-Fruit ✓

B. Seed-Tree-Sapling-Fruit

C. Sapling-Seed-Tree-Fruit

D. Seed-Fruit-Sapling-Tree

Explanation: A Seed grows into a Sapling, which matures into a Tree, which eventually bears Fruit. [easy, authored]

5. A person walks north, turns right, walks on, then turns right again. Which direction are they now facing?

A. North

B. South ✓

C. East

D. West

Explanation: Two consecutive right turns reverse the original direction: North $\rightarrow$ (right) East $\rightarrow$ (right) South. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Vocabulary: Homonyms and Homophones

READING MATERIAL

Covers homophones (words that sound alike but differ in spelling and meaning) and the specific confused-word pairs TNPSC has tested in real exams.

Q: Real exam: "The ____ for the ride was expensive" — which homophone fits, 'fare' or 'fair'?

A: FARE (the cost of a ride/journey) — not 'fair' (which means just/equitable, or a carnival event).

Q: Real exam: What is the correct homophone for 'mail'?

A: MALE (as opposed to 'myle' or 'mile', which are not true homophones of 'mail').

Q: Real exam: In "The dog wagged its tail," which word is a homophone of 'tail'?

A: TALE (a story) — not 'toile' or 'toil'.

Q: Real exam: "They rejoined the group as Sarah passed out ____ and coffee" — 'dessert' or 'desert'?

A: DESSERT (a sweet course after a meal) — not 'desert' (a dry, arid region, or to abandon).

Q: What is the difference between 'stationery' and 'stationary', and what is a useful memory trick?

A: STATIONERY = writing supplies (paper, pens, envelopes) — memory trick: 'E is for Envelope', and an envelope is something you write on, so stationERY. STATIONARY = not moving, staying in place — memory trick: 'A is for Anchored', and an anchor stops movement, so stationARY.

Q: What is the difference between 'there', 'their', and 'they're' — the most commonly confused homophone trio in English?

A: THERE = an adverb referring to a place ('put it there'). THEIR = a possessive pronoun ('their house'). THEY'RE = a contraction of 'they are' ('they're coming').

Q: What is the difference between 'practice' and 'practise', and between 'advice' and 'advise'?

A: PRACTICE (noun) vs PRACTISE (verb) — in British English spelling conventions. Similarly, ADVICE (noun, 'a piece of advice') vs ADVISE (verb, 'to advise someone').

Q: What is the difference between 'loose'/'lose' and 'affect'/'effect'?

A: LOOSE (adjective, not tight) vs LOSE (verb, to misplace/fail to win). AFFECT (verb, to influence) vs EFFECT (noun, the result of an influence).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The ____ for the ride was expensive."

- A. fair
- B. fore
- C. far

D. fare ✓

Explanation: fare. [medium, question-bank-2025]

2. Select the correct homophone for the word 'mail'.

- A. myle
- B. maile

C. male ✓

D. mile

Explanation: male. [medium, question-bank-2025]

3. "The dog wagged its tail." Which word is a homophone of the underlined word?

A. taile

B. tale ✓

C. toile

D. toil

Explanation: tale. [medium, question-bank-2025]

4. "They rejoined the group as Sarah passed out ____ and coffee."

- A. desert
- B. dirt
- C. dessert ✓**
- D. dish

Explanation: dessert. [medium, question-bank-2024]

5. "She went to the shop to buy pens, paper, and envelopes" — these items are collectively called:

- A. Stationary
- B. Stationery ✓**
- C. Statuary
- D. Statutory

Explanation: Stationery (writing supplies). [medium, web-research]

6. "The car remained ____ for over an hour due to the traffic jam" — which word fits?

- A. stationery
- B. stationary ✓**
- C. statutory
- D. statuary

Explanation: Stationary (not moving). [medium, web-research]

7. Fill in correctly: " ____ going to the market to return ____ books."

- A. They're, there
- B. There, they're
- C. They're, their ✓**
- D. Their, they're

Explanation: They're going... to return their books. [medium, web-research]

8. Which sentence uses 'advice' and 'advise' correctly?

- A. She gave me good advise; I will advice him too
- B. She gave me good advice; I will advise him too ✓**
- C. She gave me good advice; I will advice him too
- D. She gave me good advise; I will advise him too

Explanation: advice (noun), advise (verb). [medium, web-research]

9. Which sentence uses 'affect' and 'effect' correctly?

- A. The new policy will effect many people, with a lasting affect
- B. The new policy will affect many people, with a lasting effect ✓**
- C. The new policy will affect many people, with a lasting affect
- D. The new policy will effect many people, with a lasting effect

Explanation: affect (verb), effect (noun). [medium, web-research]